

prompt design: social policy field

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Tags	



this document contains considerations for the development of the prompt for the social policy field classification, which's results yield to the codebook document in the pipeline. specifically, I weigh possible sources for a typology of social policy fields here.

possible sources/references

	ESSPROS	OECD SOCX	OECD taxben
what	European system of integrated social protection statistics	oecd social expenditure database	tax benefit model of the oecd
purpose	provides a coherent comparison between European countries' social benefits to households and their financing; yearly from 1990 on; social protection receipts and expenditures by schemes; "functions"	was developed to analyse trends in social spending and its composition at the detailed social expenditure programme level	the cross-country tax and benefit simulation model developed and maintained by the OECD. It is a unique tool for exploring the detailed mechanics of tax-benefit policies and reforms on working age individuals and their families across countries
url	esspros-url	oecd-socx-url	
categories	1. sickness / health care 2. disability 3. old age 4. survivors 5. family/children 6. unemployment 7. housing 8. social exclusion	1. old age 2. survivors 3. incapacity-related benefits 4. health 5. family 6. active labour market policies 7. unemployment 8. housing 9. other	1. unemployment benefits 2. means-tested social assistance 3. housing (private renting) 4. employment-conditional/in-work 5. transitional into-work benefits 6. disability 7. family and child 8. childcare (institutional) 9. taxes (soc. sec. contrib)
definitions	social protection glossary	socx manual	

▼ ESSPROS notes

▼ def "social protection"

GlossarySocial protection
description
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Social_protection

"All interventions from public or private bodies intended to relieve households and individuals of the burden of a defined set of risks or needs, provided that there is neither a simultaneous reciprocal nor an individual arrangement involved. In ESSPROS, the list of risks or needs (functions) that may give rise to social protection is, by convention, as follows: (see list in table above!)"

▼ def "social benefits " (see glossary link above!)

GlossarySocial benefits (ESSPROS classifica
description
[https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Social_benefits_\(ESSPROS_classification\)](https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Social_benefits_(ESSPROS_classification))

"Transfers, in cash or in kind, by social protection schemes to households and individuals to relieve them of the burden of a defined set of risks or needs, that are conventionally grouped in an agreed list of functions."

▼ def "social contributions"

GlossarySocial contributions (ESSPROS clas
description
[https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Social_contributions_\(ESSPROS_classification\)](https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Social_contributions_(ESSPROS_classification))

"Social contributions include the costs incurred by employers on behalf of their employees (Employers' imputed social contributions) or by protected persons to secure entitlement to social benefits. By convention all periodic payments by protected persons, or for protected persons by their employers, into compulsory universal schemes are classified as social contributions if levied as a function of income, payroll, or the number of employees."

▼ def "sickness-health care function"

GlossarySickness-health care function
description
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Sickness-health_care_function

"This function covers:

- cash benefits that replace in whole or in part loss of earnings during temporary inability to work due to sickness or injury;
- medical care provided in the framework of social protection to maintain, restore or improve the health of the people protected."

▼ def "disability"

GlossaryDisability function
description
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Disability_function

"Disability is the full or partial inability to engage in economic activity or to lead a normal life due to a physical or mental impairment that is likely to be either permanent or to persist beyond a minimum prescribed period. Disability function covers benefits that:

- provide an income to persons below reference retirement age as established in the reference scheme whose ability to work and earn is impaired beyond a minimum level laid down by legislation by a physical or mental disability;
- provide rehabilitation services specifically required by disabilities;
- provide goods and services other than medical care to disabled people."

▼ def "old age"

GlossaryOld age function
description
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Old_age_function

"The function covers the provision of social protection against the risks linked to old age: loss of income, inadequate income, lack of independence in carrying out daily tasks, reduced participation in social life, and so on. Medical care of the elderly is not taken into account, as all health care expenditure is reported under the Sickness/health care function. The Old age function covers benefits that:

- provide a replacement income when the aged person retires from the labour market;
- guarantee a certain income when a person has reached a prescribed age;
- provide goods or services specifically required by the personal or social circumstances of the elderly."

▼ def "survivors function"

GlossarySurvivors function
description
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Survivors_function

"The Survivors' function includes benefits that:

- provide a temporary or permanent income to people who have suffered from the loss of the spouse or a next-of-kin, usually when the latter represented the main breadwinner for the beneficiary;
- compensate survivors for funeral costs for any hardship caused by the death of a family member;
- provide goods and services to eligible survivors.

Survivors eligible for benefit may be the spouse or ex-spouse of the deceased person, his or her children, grandchildren, parents or other relatives. In some cases, the benefit may also be paid to someone outside the family."

▼ def "family/children"

GlossaryFamily-children function
description
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Family-children_function

"This function includes benefits that:

- provide financial support to households for bringing up children;
- provide financial assistance to people who support relatives other than children;
- provide social services specifically designed to assist and protect the family, particularly children."

▼ def "unemployment"

https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Unemployment_function

"This function includes benefits that:

- replace in whole or in part income lost by a worker due to the loss of gainful employment;
- provide a subsistence (or better) income to persons entering or re-entering the labour market;
- compensate for the loss of earnings due to partial unemployment;
- replace in whole or in part income lost by an older worker who retires from gainful employment before the reference retirement age because of job reductions for economic reasons;
- contribute to the cost of training or re-training people looking for employment;
- help unemployed persons meet the cost of travelling or relocating to obtain employment;
- provide help and relief by providing appropriate goods and services."

▼ def "housing"

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<span class="mw-page-title-namespace">Glossary</span><span class="mw-page-title-separator">:</span><span class="mw-page-title-main">Housing function</span>
description
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Housing_function
```

"Interventions by public authorities to help households meet the cost of housing, (rent benefits, social housing, benefits to owner-occupiers are possible examples). Housing policies are widespread in the Member States and their purpose often goes beyond that of social protection: they may be aimed at encouraging the building industry, ownership of dwellings, saving and so on. These wider measures are not within the scope of ESSPROS."

▼ def "social exclusion not elsewhere classified function"

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<span class="mw-page-title-namespace">Glossary</span><span class="mw-page-title-separator">:</span><span class="mw-page-title-main">Social exclusion not elsewhere clas
description
https://ec.europa.eu/eurostat/statistics-explained/index.php?title=Glossary:Social_exclusion_not_elsewhere_classified_function
```

"This function includes benefits in cash or kind (except health care) specifically intended to combat social exclusion where they are not covered by one of the other functions. The concept of social exclusion is multidimensional, but it refers firstly to an insufficient level of income (poverty). Apart from income support, the content of this function is fairly heterogeneous, however, its borderlines are traced by the definition of social protection, and by the following principles:

- small-scale, informal and incidental types of support that do not require regular management and accounting are conventionally excluded from the scope of ESSPROS.
- all social benefits related to a risk or need for which ESSPROS defines a specific function are reported under that function.
- while the other functions refer to people subject to clearly identifiable risks or needs (the elderly, the disabled, the unemployed and so on), this function refers to the "socially excluded" or to "those at risk of social exclusion."

▼ OECD SOCX notes

 The OECD SOCX Manual
2019 Edition: A guide to the OECD Social Expenditure Database

▼ def "social expenditure"

"The provision by public and private institutions of benefits to, and financial contributions targeted at, households and individuals in order to provide support during circumstances which adversely affect their welfare, provided that the provision of the benefits and financial contributions constitutes neither a direct payment for a particular good or service nor an individual contract or transfer." (8)

"only benefits provided by institutions are included" (8)

▼ def "social benefits"

"Social benefits include cash benefits (e.g., pensions, income support during maternity leave and social assistance payments), social services (e.g., childcare, care for the elderly and persons with disabilities) and tax breaks with a social purpose (e.g., fiscal support for families with children, or favourable tax treatment of contributions to private health plans)." (8)

▼ def nine policy areas

- **Old age** – pensions (Box 2), early retirement pensions, home-help and residential services for the elderly;
- **Survivors** – pensions and funeral payments;
- **Inccapacity-related benefits** – care services, disability benefits, benefits accruing from occupational injury and accident legislation, employee sickness payments;
- **Health** – spending on in- and out-patient care, medical goods, prevention;
- **Family** – child allowances and credits, childcare support, income support during leave, single parent payments;
- **Active labour market policies** – employment services, training, employment incentives, integration of persons with disabilities, direct job creation, and start-up incentives;
- **Unemployment** – unemployment compensation, early retirement for labour market reasons;

- **Housing** – housing allowances and rent subsidies;
- **Other social policy areas** – non-categorical cash benefits to low-income households, and/or other social services; e.g. legal aid in the Netherlands or the Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP), formerly Food Stamps in the United States.

Table 2. Categorisation of public and mandatory private social expenditure in SOCX
Public and mandatory private programmes by social policy area and type of support (cash/in kind).

1. OLD AGE	5. FAMILY
Cash benefits	Cash benefits
Pension	Family allowances
Early retirement pension	Maternity and parental leave
Other cash benefits	Other cash benefits
Benefits in kind	Benefits in kind
Residential care / Home-help services	Early childhood education and care (ECEC)
Other benefits in kind	Home help / Accommodation
	Other benefits in kind
2. SURVIVORS	6. ACTIVE LABOUR MARKET PROGRAMMES
Cash benefits	PES and administration
Pension	Training
Other cash benefits	Employment incentives
Benefits in kind	Sheltered and supported employment and rehabilitation
Funeral expenses	Direct job creation
Other benefits in kind	Start-up incentives
3. INCAPACITY-RELATED BENEFITS	7. UNEMPLOYMENT
Cash benefits	Cash benefits
Disability pensions	Unemployment compensation / severance pay
Pensions (occupational injury and disease)	Early retirement for labour market reasons
Paid sick leave (occupational injury and disease)	Benefits in kind
Paid sick leave (other sickness daily allowances)	
Other cash benefits	8. HOUSING
Benefits in kind	Benefits in kind
Residential care / Home-help services	Housing assistance
Rehabilitation services	Other benefits in kind
Other benefits in kind	
4. HEALTH	9. OTHER SOCIAL POLICY AREAS
Benefits in kind	Cash benefits
	Income maintenance
	Other cash benefits
	Benefits in kind
	Social assistance
	Other benefits in kind

Source: OECD.

p. 16

▼ OECD taxben

▼ unemployment benefits

"Unemployment insurance benefits are designed to support the income and facilitate effective job search by smoothing consumption of people who lost a previous job. Insurance benefits are typically linked to previous earnings and require previous employment record and social contribution payments. This distinguishes them from unemployment assistance benefits (Section 3.5.3), which are usually means-tested benefits and either provide a second-tier safety net for those who have exhausted their rights to unemployment insurance, or serve as a principal form of income support for jobseekers who were not entitled in the first place (e.g., because they just entered the labour force or otherwise lack the employment history that would be needed for claiming insurance benefits)" (16)

▼ means-tested social assistance (incl. guaranteed minimum income)

"Jobseekers who do not qualify for unemployment insurance benefits, or whose entitlement to these benefits are low or have expired, can claim unemployment assistance (UA) and/or social assistance or minimum-income (SA) benefits. These benefits are usually means-tested, that is, receipt is conditional on individual and/or family income and assets. In addition, entitlement to some UA benefits may depend on past employment or contribution records, or they may be available only as a follow-up to insurance benefits, but not as a replacement for jobseekers who were not previously entitled to insurance support. When entitlement to means-tested UA depends on age or previous work history, the assumptions are the same as for unemployment insurance." (19)

▼ housing for privately rented accommodations

"TaxBEN incorporates housing benefit (HB) rules for people living in privately rented accommodation. Benefit entitlements for other housing tenures are not simulated. For example, subsidies for the construction of housing, purchases of owner-occupied housing, favourable interest payments, or in-kind support for those in social housing, etc. are not included. Specific cash support for housing-related expenditures other than rent, e.g. heating and water bills, are outside the scope of the model. However, if part of housing benefits aim to cover utility costs, and cannot be identified separately, calculated housing benefits include these components as well. If housing benefits are means tested, the assumptions concerning means-testing are the same as those used when modelling social and unemployment assistance benefits." (20)

▼ employment-conditional / in-work benefits

"TaxBEN covers employment-conditional ("in-work") benefits (IW) that are conditional on the following key requirements:

- Being employed on a regular basis with a standard employment contract;
- Working a certain number of hours and/or earning more than a certain minimum.

[...] This notably excludes 'workfare' programmes and related 'work-first' policies that make out-of-work benefits conditional on participation in work activities. Benefits that are in IW calculations (though they may be accounted for in other parts of TaxBEN calculations)." (23)

▼ transitional "into-work" benefits

"Some countries operate one-off or temporary benefits that are available following a recent transition into work, e.g., during a predefined period after taking up new employment." (23)

▼ disability

"[...] The scope is limited to long-term disability schemes. Other types of health-related benefits are not covered (including short-term sickness benefits, benefits designed to support those providing care to incapacitated persons, allowances designed to cover disability-related costs or needs, and special benefits for those who have been disabled since childhood)." (24)

▼ family and child benefits

"Family benefits (FB) are income support programmes that are conditional on having children or adult dependants. [...] " Benefits that are conditional on using formal centre-based childcare for parents of pre-school children are instead classified as 'childcare benefits' [different category!]. [...] By contrast,

'homecare' allowances that are designed to support parents who look after their children and are conditional on not using centre-based childcare are included in the FB category. [...] In the standard TaxBEN model, FB do not include maternity and other birth-related benefits. Those benefits are part of a separate TaxBEN module. Some countries operate specific benefit provisions for lone parents, or they provide state guarantees for certain minimum amounts of alimony child support payments in cases where the absent parent does not or cannot provide such support. As a general rule, such benefits are included in TaxBEN if they are paid on regular basis for a long period." (22)

▼ childcare benefits

"Childcare benefits are income support measures whose eligibility is conditional on the use of centre-based childcare. They can take the form of (i) fee rebates applied directly by the childcare centre, (ii) universal or means-tested cash allowances, (iii) increase entitlements in other benefit programmes, and (iv) tax reductions. Fee rebates include cases where some families can access childcare free of charge for some or all of their children, or where fees differentiate based on family income and circumstances, or the characteristics of the child (e.g. age)." (25-6)

▼ taxes (and soc. security contributions)

Taxes: "taxes and social security contributions on employment incomes and cash benefits, e.g. accounting for any special tax treatments of unemployment and family benefits. It accounts also for specific tax regulations that apply to the family and labour market characteristics of taxpayers within the scope of the TaxBEN model." (27)

Only personal income taxes payable in respect of employment earnings and benefits are included." (28)

"social security contributions paid by employees and employers." (29)

Non-tax compulsory payments: "TaxBEN also incorporates any Non-Tax Compulsory Payments (NTCPs) made by employers or employees in connection with the employees' labour activity. Examples are mandatory payments to private health or pension providers." (29)

▼ my own typology



this section compiles a typology for the purpose of comprehensively tracking social policies and categorizing them into fields based on the three typology approaches above. the aim is to maximize breadth, that is to be able to capture social policies from as many angles as possible. all three of these typologies serve specific purposes and therefore differentiate more granularly on some ends and leave gaps on others. The rules to develop the definitions are as follows:

- definitions follow as much as possible those of the three typologies
- between the three, the broadest definition is prioritized
- meaningful additions are made the broadest definition leaves out relevant aspects that may, if not included, lead to false exclusions of policies
- meaningful additions are kept parsimoniously and rare

category	taken from	definition
unemployment	all three	Regard benefits and social security contributions that serve to "• replace in whole or in part income lost by a worker due to the loss of gainful employment; • provide a subsistence (or better) income to persons entering or re-entering the labour market; • compensate for the loss of earnings due to partial unemployment; • replace in whole or in part income lost by an older worker who retires from gainful employment before the reference retirement age because of job reductions for economic reasons; • contribute to the cost of training or re-training people looking for employment; • help unemployed persons meet the cost of travelling or relocating to obtain employment; • provide help and relief by providing appropriate goods and services." (ESSPROS) • provide for jobseekers who do not qualify for unemployment insurance benefits, or whose entitlement to these benefits is low or has expired (OECD taxben) • prescribe a universal basic income
family/children	all three	Regard benefits and measures that: • provide financial support to households for bringing up children; • provide financial assistance to people who support relatives other than children; • provide social services specifically designed to assist and protect the family, particularly children." (ESSPROS) • enhance access to or expand the availability of child care facilities • regulate child alimony between parents If the measure is concretely designed as a tax cut/advantage, then the policy falls under the class "taxes".

category	taken from	definition
housing	all three	Regard benefits and measures that • help households meet the cost of housing, for example through rent benefits, social housing, benefits to owner-occupiers" (ESSPROS) • subsidies for heating, water and electricity expenditures (spec. excluded in OECD taxben) • aim to end homelessness through "housing first" policies • increase the availability of social housing
disability	all three	Regards policies that "• provide an income to persons whose full or partial inability to engage in economic activity or to lead a normal life, due to a physical or mental impairment that is likely to be permanent or to persist beyond a minimum prescribed period, impairs their ability to work and earn beyond a minimum level laid down by legislation" (ESSPROS) • provide allowances designed to cover disability-related costs or needs (excluded by OECD taxben) This class excludes short-term sickness benefits, which fall under "health and care," and benefits for persons providing care to incapacitated individuals, which fall under "family/children." (OECD taxben)
retirement	SOCX, ESSPROS (OECD taxben only through soc sec contribution)	Regards benefits, social security contributions and measures that "• provide a replacement income when the aged person retires from the labour market; • guarantee a certain income when a person has reached a prescribed age" (ESSPROS) Benefits and contributions for medical and elderly care are not included and instead fall under the class "health/care." (OECD taxben) • regulate private retirement provisions
survivors	SOCX, ESSPROS	Regards benefits that "• provide a temporary or permanent income to people [because they] have suffered from the loss of the spouse or a next-of-kin, usually when the latter represented the main breadwinner for the beneficiary; • compensate survivors for funeral costs for any hardship caused by the death of a family member; • provide goods and services to eligible survivors." (ESSPROS)
sickness/health/care	SOCX, ESSPROS (OECD taxben only through soc sec contribution)	Regard benefits, social security contributions and measures that "• replace in whole or in part loss of earnings during temporary inability to work due to sickness or injury; • medical care provided in the framework of social protection to maintain, restore or improve the health of the people protected." (ESSPROS) "• provide goods or services specifically required by the personal or social circumstances of the elderly" (ESSPROS old age) • concern the institutional setup of health insurance systems, both public and private
(active) labour market policies	SOCX (OECD taxben to a limited extend)	Regards measures that • regulate employment service institutions • regulate wages, minimum wages or working hours • regulate non-standard, atypical employment and employment exempt from social security contributions • prohibit illegal employment • foster direct job creation • provide start-up incentives • provide hiring or wage subsidies to employers to higher specific groups
taxes	OECD taxben	Regards all personal income taxes payable in respect of employment and self-employment earnings. Also includes measure concretely designed as a tax cut/advantage for families with children or who provide assistance to a care-dependant relative.